# Jan Pfänder

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## Positions

**Swiss Federal Institute of Aquatic Science and Technology (Eawag)** — Zurich, Switzerland
Postdoctoral researcher — Sep 2025 – present
- Advisor: Viktoria Cologna

**ETH Zurich** — Zurich, Switzerland
Lecturer — Sep 2026 – present

**Cambridge University** — Cambridge, UK
Visiting Researcher — May 2026 – Jun 2026
- Host: Sander van der Linden

## Education

**PhD** **École Normale Supérieure (ENS-PSL), Institut Jean Nicod**, Psychology — Paris, France, 2022 – 2025
- Supervisors: Hugo Mercier & Kevin Arceneaux
- Thesis: Essays on Understanding Trust in Science

**MA** **École Normale Supérieure (ENS-PSL)**, Cognitive Science — Paris, France, 2020 – 2022
- Supervisor: Hugo Mercier
- Thesis: Can we infer people are accurate and competent merely because they agree with each other?

**MA** **Universität Freiburg**, Journalism (1st year) — Freiburg, Germany, 2019 – 2020

**BA** **Universität Konstanz**, Political Science and Public Administration — Konstanz, Germany, 2014 – 2018

## Work Experience

**Direction Interministérielle de la Transformation Publique (DITP)** — Paris, France
Research Intern — Jun 2021 – Aug 2021

**Assemblée Nationale** — Paris, France
Parliamentary Assistant — Sep 2018 – Jul 2019

**University of St. Gallen** — St. Gallen, Switzerland
Research Assistant — Jun 2017 – Jul 2018

## Publications

Peer-reviewed publications
(*n* = 6)

Global Studies on Trust in Science Suggest New Theoretical and Methodological Directions — 2026
**J. Pfänder**, N. G. Mede, V. Cologna
*Current Opinion in Psychology*

Sciences Perceived as Precise and Consensual Are More Trusted — 2026
**J. Pfänder**, H. Mercier
*Public Understanding of Science*

How Wise Is the Crowd: Can We Infer People Are Accurate and Competent Merely Because They Agree with Each Other? — 2025
**J. Pfänder**, B. de Courson, H. Mercier
*Cognition*

Quasi-Universal Acceptance of Basic Science in the United States — 2025
**J. Pfänder**, L. Kerzreho, H. Mercier
*Public Understanding of Science*

Spotting False News and Doubting True News: A Systematic Review and Meta-Analysis of News Judgements 2025
**J. Pfänder**, S. Altay
*Nature Human Behaviour*

Trusting But Forgetting Impressive Science 2025
**J. Pfänder**, S. de Rouilhan, H. Mercier
*Journal of Cognition and Culture*

Conference proceedings
(*n* = 1)

How Wise Is the Crowd: Can We Infer People Are Accurate and Competent Merely Because They Agree with Each Other? 2024
**J. Pfänder**, B. de Courson, H. Mercier
*Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*

Large collaborations (minor role)
(*n* = 3)

Investigating the Analytical Robustness of the Social and Behavioural Sciences 2026
B. Aczel, B. Szaszi, H. T. Clelland, …, **J. Pfänder**, … et al.
*Nature*

Trust in Scientists and Their Role in Society across 68 Countries 2025
V. Cologna, N. G. Mede, S. Berger, …, **J. Pfänder**, … et al.
*Nature Human Behaviour*

Perceptions of Science, Science Communication, and Climate Change Attitudes in 68 Countries – the TISP Dataset 2025
N. G. Mede, V. Cologna, S. Berger, …, **J. Pfänder**, … et al.
*Scientific Data*

Working papers
(*n* = 1)

The Rational Impression Account of Trust in Science 2025
**J. Pfänder**, H. Mercier

## Grants

**Swiss National Science Foundation (SNSF) exchange grant** 2026
Research visit to Cambridge University (host: Sander van der Linden), 5'000 CHF

## Presentations

**Invited talks**

**Strengthening Trust in Climate Scientists in the US - A Megastudy Approach** 2026
Max Planck Institute for Human Development, Berlin

**Trust in science** 2025
Paris School of International Affairs (Sciences Po), Paris

**Conference presentations**

**How different demographic groups respond to interventions aimed at increasing trust in climate scientists** 2026
54th DGPs Congress (German Psychological Society), Luxembourg

**Alienation and Trust in Climate Scientists in the United States** 2026
Workshop 'Knowing how to know in a complex world: Philosophical and empirical perspectives' (LMU Munich), Munich

**Trusting but forgetting impressive science** 2026
EASP General Meeting, Strasbourg

**Strengthening Trust in Climate Scientists in the US - A Megastudy Approach** 2026
EASP Small Meeting, Hohenheim

**Predicting the effects of a megastudy with behavioral clones** 2026
Behavioral Clones Workshop (Max Planck Institute for Human Development), Berlin

**Belief in & interventions against misinformation** 2025
15th Annual Conference of the European Political Science Association, Madrid

**The rational impression account of trust in science** 2025
Explaining culture: an interdisciplinary approach, Paris

**Spotting False News and Doubting True News. A Meta-Analysis of News Judgments (Keynote)** 2025
Infox sur Seine, Paris

**How wise is the crowd: Can we infer people are accurate and competent merely because they agree with each other? (Poster)** 2024
46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Rotterdam

**Processus sous-tendant la confiance dans la science** 2024
5ème édition des Rencontres Jeunes Chercheur·euse·s, Grenoble

**Spotting False News and Doubting True News: A Meta-Analysis of News Judgments** 2024
EDMO Scientific Conference on Disinformation, Amsterdam

## Teaching

**Courses**

**The Psychology of Climate Change Communication: theoretical insights and practical applications [website]** 2026
ETH Zurich
- Co-taught with Viktoria Cologna
- 24.5h in-class per semester (14 weekly sessions)

**Introduction to Research Design [website]** 2022 – 2025
Université PSL (Paris Sciences & Lettres)
- Sole instructor & creator of the course
- 30h in-class per semester; one semester a year

**Workshops**

**Meta-analysis for beginners** 2024
Laboratoire de Psychologie du Développement et de l'Éducation de l'Enfant (LaPsyDÉ)

## Advising

**Graduate students**
- Pauline Barsky (2026)
- Lou Kerzreho (2023)

**Undergraduate students**
- Mateo Pivert (2024)
- Ludivine Million (2024)
- Prune Lefevre Jachimowicz (2024)
- Kevin Chen (2023)
- Théodore Lellouche (2022)

## Professional Service

**Peer Reviewing**
($n$ = 14)
- Journals: *Public Understanding of Science* (3), *Journal of Environmental Psychology* (2), *Artificial Intelligence Review* (1), *Behavior Research Methods* (1), *Društvena istraživanja* (1), *Educational Research Review* (1), *Nature Climate Change* (1), *Nature Communications* (1), *PNAS Nexus* (1), *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin* (1), *Social Science & Medicine* (1)

## Summer Schools

**Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute** St. Andrews, UK
Hosted by the University of St. Andrews, organized by Indiana University Bloomington 2024

## Skills

**Languages:** German, English, French, Spanish

**Programming:** R, Git (basics), Python (rudimentary)